Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A J 8 7 6 3
♥ A Q 7
♦ K Q
♣ 8 7

♠ Q
♥ 4 3 2
♦ A 10 7 5 3 2
♣ J 9 2

♠ 10
♥ J 10 9 8 5
♦ 9 8 6
♣ A 10 6 4

♠ K 9 5 4 2
♥ K 6
♦ J 4
♣ K Q 5 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♥J

When partner opens 1♠ you have a pretty normal Jacoby 2NT response. He next says 3♠.

Your partner has a better than minimum hand with 6 ♠s. However, you have an average hand with no controls to show so you use the Principle of Fast Arrival and bid 4♠. Everyone passes.

Board 2
South Deals
None Vul

♠ A K 3
♥ K J 9 5
♦ K Q J 3
♣ 9 7

♠ J 10 8 5
♥ 6 4
♦ 9 6 2
♣ A 8 4 2

♠ 9 6 2
♥ 7 2
♦ A 10 5 4
♣ J 10 5 3

♠ Q 7 4
♥ A Q 10 8 3
♦ 8 7
♣ K Q 6

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	4♥
Pass	4♠	Pass	5♥
All Pass			

5♥ by South
Lead: ♠J

Partner's bid is game forcing. With a bare minimum, no singletons, you go ahead and sign off in game. Partner then says 4♠.

Partner is definitely showing slam interest. If you had a first round control in either Minor suit you would bid it now. But you don't. So you sign of again, this time at 5♥. Partner finally gives up on the idea of slam and passes.

Board 3
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 9 8 7 5 3
♥ 9 5
♦ K Q J 10
♣ A

♠ 6
♥ Q 8 6 4 3
♦ A 8 2
♣ J 10 3 2

♠ 10
♥ A K J 10 7 2
♦ 6 4
♣ 9 7 6 5

♠ K Q J 4 2
♥ —
♦ 9 7 5 3
♣ K Q 8 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	4♥
Pass	5♣	Pass	5♥
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			

6♠ by North
Lead: ♥K

You want to force partner to game while you describe your hand. So you make a Splinter Bid of 4♥. Partner replies 5♣.

Partner has the ♣A. Good. You are pretty worried about ♦s and also your 11 high card points. You are tempted to just sign off at 5♠ but you shouldn't. You can make a control-bid below the 5♠ level. So you bid 5♥. This tells partner that your Splinter must have been a ♥ void. Partner bids 6♠.

Board 4
South Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q 6 4 3
♥ 7 6
♦ A K Q
♣ K Q J

♠ 2
♥ K 9 4 3
♦ 9 7 5 3 2
♣ 9 6 5

♠ 9 5
♥ J 10 8 5 2
♦ 10 8 6
♣ 7 4 2

♠ A J 10 8 7
♥ A Q
♦ J 4
♣ A 10 8 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
Pass	4♦	Pass	4♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]
Pass	7♠		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 3 aces

7♠ by South
Lead: ♦2

With 17 points you need to indicate a better than minimum opening. You have no singletons and just a 5-card trump suit so you bid 3NT. Partner says 4♦ and it is your bid again.

Partner's 4♦ bid shows first round control (surely the Ace). You bid 4♥, showing your first round control. Partner now says 4NT.

You are being Blackwooded, and with three Aces you reply 5♠. That was apparently just what North wanted to hear, so he bid 7♠.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ 7 4 3 ♥ A 10 8 5 2 ♦ K J ♣ K Q 9	
♠ J 5 2 ♥ 7 4 ♦ 10 9 8 2 ♣ A 7 6 3		♠ A K Q 10 8 ♥ 9 6 ♦ 5 3 ♣ J 8 5 4
	♠ 9 6 ♥ K Q J 3 ♦ A Q 7 6 4 ♣ 10 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	1♠	2♠
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♠K

You were all set to give a Jacoby 2NT response when East stuck in his 1♠ overcall. Now you can't because Jacoby is off after opponents interfere. Fortunately you have another bid at your disposal. You say 2♠, showing good ♥s and a limit raise or better. Partner bids 3♥.

Partner didn't have enough to bid game, not knowing if you had more than 11 points. But you know you have opening hand so you bid 4♥.